

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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AI solutions builder who embeds with business teams, traces a workflow to where the time actually goes, and ships the agent that takes the repetitive part off them. Three years running engagements end to end at my own consultancy: workflow discovery, build, deployment, and the enablement that leaves the team able to run and extend it without me. Every engagement measured against a baseline, including a pre-sales workflow cut 98% in processing time and an ingestion pipeline moved 99.8% higher in throughput at 86% lower cost. Over two years inside IBM building AI and data tools for a customer-support organization, adopted by the front-line teams whose queues they changed.

Core Competencies

- **Workflow discovery & process mapping:** embed with a team, map current-state workflows end to end, and separate the steps worth automating from the ones that only look repetitive; the discovery session is a working session, not a slide deck
- **Claude-powered agents & internal tools:** build and deploy agents with the Claude API, MCP (Model Context Protocol), and Claude Code, plus LLM tool-calling across OpenAI and Gemini; production systems, not prototypes
- **Enablement & capability building:** hand the build over deliberately, train the team to build the next one themselves, and judge the engagement on what still runs after I leave rather than on what shipped
- **Impact measurement:** set the baseline before building, then report the delta in the business's own numbers (processing time, throughput, cost, time-to-resolution)
- **Stakeholder influence & translation:** move skeptical operators from "this will not work on my process" to running it themselves; present findings and ROI to C-level stakeholders
- **Self-directed delivery:** sole builder on every engagement since 2023, scoping, pricing, and shipping without a dedicated engineering partner
- **Reusable patterns & scale:** turn a one-off automation into a template the next team can pick up, documented so it travels without me in the room; three years of engagements run on the same repeatable discovery-to-handover process
- **Technical foundation:** Python (7+ yrs professional), TypeScript/Next.js, SQL/PostgreSQL, n8n, data pipelines, BI dashboards (Tableau, Cognos)

Professional Experience

- **StaffRoom AI** **Emeryville, CA**
Founder & AI Solutions Consultant *2023–Present*
 - Embed with client operating teams to map end-to-end workflows, identify the highest-impact automation targets, then design, build, and deploy the solution as the only technical person on the engagement
 - Automated an IT MSP's pre-sales cybersecurity risk assessments, reducing processing time 98% against a measured baseline, then trained the team to run and extend the workflow without me
 - Modernized a data-analytics platform's ingestion pipeline, increasing throughput 99.8% in 4 months while cutting cost 86%
 - Build production agent and LLM tooling since 2023: Claude API tool-calling, MCP servers, Claude Code, and n8n automations put in front of non-technical teams as their daily tools
 - Built data pipelines and an ML model for anti-trafficking nonprofit Allies Against Slavery, ingesting federal case documents to power the *Lighthouse* analytics dashboard their team runs day to day
 - Ship production Notion API integrations in TypeScript and Python: a public OAuth (Connections) app, a comments-polling service, and a Whisper-to-Notion pipeline with CI that tests live API connectivity
- **Wiz Music** **Barcelona, Spain**
Community Development Intern *2022*
 - Grew and stewarded a global, multilingual (English/Spanish/Catalan) builder-and-creator community around an early-stage music startup, and built Python automation to streamline investor outreach

- **Valhalla Healthcare** **Remote**
Machine Learning Engineer (Intern) 2021
 - Built an ML model translating handwritten clinical notes into an extensible data model (F1 80.03), putting a usable AI tool in front of a non-technical clinical team
- **IBM** **Austin, TX**
Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer, Customer Support 2018–2020
 - Built DRE Bot, a Watson NLP Slack app for a customer-support operation, surfacing similar past cases to support engineers and cutting time-to-resolution for the most common customer issues to a single response; adoption held at three-month team check-ins
 - Designed and deployed IBMLogAnalyze, a GDPR-compliant data pipeline and analytics dashboard that eliminated 1–3 hours of per-case log-analysis prep
 - Led Design Thinking discovery sessions to surface business needs, launched BI dashboards delivering operational insight to C-level executives, and authored the release notes that walked stakeholders through each change

Selected Projects

- **Agentic job-search system:** a Claude Code workspace of custom skills and subagents that scrapes postings, scores fit against a structured profile, and drafts tailored documents, with the evaluation framework versioned and calibrated against outcomes
- **notion.md:** version-controlled Markdown mirror of a full Notion workspace, with architecture decision records so the next person can follow the pattern instead of rediscovering it
- **“Ocean-Tech” gatherings:** an early-stage lightning-talk series I started, bringing Bay Area engineers, founders, and sailors together on the water

Education & Certifications

- **University of Colorado Boulder** **Boulder, CO**
B.S. Information Science 2018–2023
 Major GPA 3.7 · Certificate of Cognitive Science · Dean's List (Fall 2019, Spring 2023). Coursework in Applied Machine Learning, User-Centered Design, and Information Ecosystems.
- **IBM Systems & Solutions Architecture Professional Certificate:** in progress; completed Business Process Modeling, Analysis and Improvement; IT Systems Design and Analysis; Cloud Native, DevOps, Agile
- **Deep Learning Specialization · TensorFlow Developer Professional Certificate,** DeepLearning.AI (2020–2021)

Awards & References

- **2nd Place, IBM Hackathon for Racial Justice** (2020): Team Lead and Data Scientist for a diverse intern team, presenting insights to executive judges
- References available upon request.